

Physics with specialization in Lasers and Spectroscopy from Banaras Hindu University. The intellectual rigor demanded by quantum mechanics and electromagnetic theory instilled precision, discipline, and respect for first principles—qualities that later proved invaluable in an industry where actuarial accuracy determines long-term sustainability.

In 1991, driven by curiosity and challenge, he appeared for the insurance examination and emerged as the youngest Class One officer at New India Assurance. The timing was pivotal. India was liberalizing its economy, dismantling decades of regulatory control and opening service sectors long dominated by public monopolies. Over the next decade, Dr. Singhel acquired what he describes as an "MBA from Street University," rotating across underwriting, claims, information technology, accounts, marketing, and sales. These experiences involved real customers, real risks, and real consequences—far removed from theoretical case studies.

In 2001, as India's insurance sector opened to private participation, he joined Bajaj Allianz General Insurance as a founding member. The joint venture between Bajaj Finserv and Allianz SE achieved first-year profitability—an exceptional achievement in a market dominated by entrenched public-sector insurers.

Reflecting on his unconventional career path, he once remarked, "People would ask me which Ivy League university I studied at. I would tell them I did my MBA from Street University." This belief became a personal mission: to demonstrate that leadership is built through experience, discipline, and integrity rather than formal credentials alone.

Under Dr. Singhel's leadership in various roles, Bajaj Allianz became India's insurance innovation laboratory. In 2002, it launched the country's first online policy issuance. In 2004, it established the first in-house health claims settlement facility. In 2006, it became the first private general insurer to cross ₹100 crore in net profits. The company pioneered bancassurance partnerships and multi-channel distribution strategies, while Dr. Singhel handled international assignments for Allianz's retail business in China and led bancassurance initiatives across Asia-Pacific, absorbing global best practices.

On April 23, 2012, at the age of forty-five, Dr. Singhel was appointed Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer. Under his strategic leadership, the pace of transformation accelerated. The company launched India's first individual cyber insurance product in 2018, introduced fully digital virtual sales offices, and enabled instant motor claim settlements through artificial intelligence-powered systems.

Yet his most defining contribution was philosophical rather than technological. Dr. Singhel believed that insurance should not remain an elite privilege limited to salaried urban populations. He championed micro-insurance products priced as low as one rupee per day, extending protection to farmers, migrant workers, and the informal sector. Over thirty million farmers received crop insurance protection, while more than 150 million employees and their families gained health coverage through employer partnerships and government schemes.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, Bajaj Allianz's systems faced their most severe stress test. The company processed over 2.5 million health claims worth more than ₹8,000 crore without arbitrary denials or procedural delays. Claim settlement times reduced from weeks to hours through video assessments, instant cashless approvals, and data-driven fraud detection.

Dr. Singhel's communication style became equally distinctive. Recognized as LinkedIn Top Voice India (2018–2019), he engaged directly with employees and customers through initiatives such as "Tea & Tales," the #StreetMBA series, and his personal blog My Take. Remarkably, he personally responded to customer grievances on social media—an uncommon practice for the head of a ₹20,000-crore organization. FY2024 closed with gross written premium of ₹21,583 crore